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Chapter 4

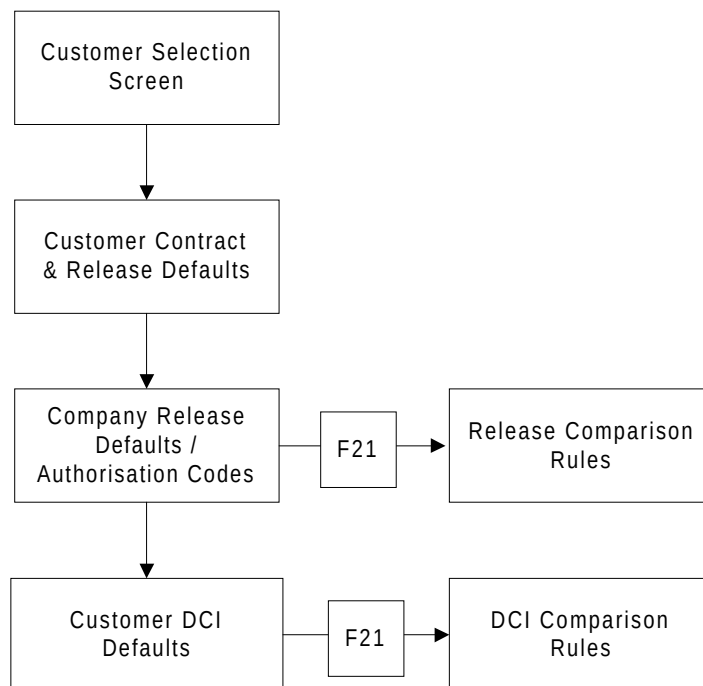
Utilities



Company Profile Maintenance

1... **2...** 1/ACU

Advanced Customer Scheduling Company Profile defaults are entered from the Company Profile screen. There are six possible input screens, which are linked together as follows:



Company Profile Maintenance Selection Screen

- Select Company Profile Maintenance from the menu to display the Company Profile Maintenance screen.

AC010User QPGMR 29/01/96 9:40:26

Company Profile Maintenance

Company code?.. █

F3=Exit F4=Prompt

05-25 **SP** **MK** KS IM II KENB20A PET007S1

Fields:

Company Code

Enter the code of the company that you want to maintain.

- Press **Enter** to display the Company Defaults and Release Defaults screen.

Company Defaults Contracts Screen



Press **Enter** from the Company Profile Maintenance screen to display the Company Defaults Contracts screen.

AC030	Demonstration Company	User QPGMR	29/01/96
			9:41:31
Company Defaults - Contracts			
DCI/RAN processing 1 (0/1/2) 0=No 1=DCI 2=DCI RAN			
Last contract number used . 0000020			
Company Defaults - Release Information			
Call-Off type 1 0=Daily 1=Timed			
Default time :15			
Reconciliation method ...?. 02 last despatch note			
Arrears processing method?. 01 Normal Arrears			
Authorisation method 04 Fixed horizon in calendar days			
Automatic update from EDI?. 4 Validate, compare and accept			
Validation rule -			
Creation rule -			
Unique date/time 1 (0/1) Hold engineering changes .. 0 (0/1)			
Text processing method...?. 0 Drop text on consolidation			
F3=Exit F4=Prompt F12=Previous			
05-30 S2 MK KS IM II KENB20A PET007S1			

Fields:

DCI / RAN Processing

Enter the processing indicator. The default is 0.

0 - Daily Call In's and RANs will not be processed

1 - Daily Call In's are to be processed.

2 - RAN details are to be processed.

Last Contract Number Used

This shows the last contract number used by the system. You can manually assign a contract numbers, or assign the next number based on this field.

Company Defaults - Release Information

Call Off Type

This field is used to determine whether the deliveries are made to a time.

Enter 1 if deliveries are timed.

Enter 0 if deliveries are not timed. This is the default.

Default Time

This is where you enter a default time for timed deliveries. This is the time the goods will normally be delivered. Enter the time in HH:MM format. The default is 00:00.

Reconciliation Method

This indicates the type of data supplied by the customer for reconciling new issues. The default is blank, forcing an entry. The descriptions are held in the Descriptions file RECM.

'01' - cumulative quantity

'02' - last despatch note

'03' - both (cumulative quantity and last despatch)

'04' - assumed

'05' - Nissan RAN

'06' - none

Arrears Processing Method

This is the method of processing arrears. The default is blank. The descriptions are held on the Descriptions file type - ARPM.

'01' - normal arrears. The customer either sends a total of arrears or sends dated requirements which are dated before the issue date.

'02' - restated arrears. The customer restates the arrears either as a new requirement or accumulated in with the forward release. The net result is that the arrears are dated on or after the new issue date.

'03' - assumed arrears. The customer does not send arrears information but assumes that the supplier will still send overdue requirements.

Authorisation Method

Enter the method used to determine the authorisation code. The default is blank. The descriptions are held on the Descriptions file type - AUMD.

'01' - authorisation code. The customer sends the appropriate code, via EDI, or it is manually entered.

'02' - date horizons. The customer sends date horizons which vary from release to release.

'03' - cumulative quantity. The customer sends cumulative quantities which vary from release to release.

'04' - fixed horizons in calendar days. Date horizons are determined using the fixed horizons in days relative to the synchronisation date of the release. The fixed horizons normally remain the same during the life of a contract.

Automatic Update From EDI

This is the automatic update from EDI indicator. The default is blank. Enter one of the following values:

0 - No EDI update

1 - Process into AI files only

2 - Validate only

3 - Validate and run comparison

4 - Validate, run comparison and update current if all is OK.

Validation Rule

This is the rule for validating EDI transmissions. The descriptions are held on the Descriptions file type - VARU.

Creation Rule

This is the rule for mapping EDI transmissions. The descriptions are held on the Descriptions file type - CRRU.

Unique Date/Time

This is the unique date / time indicator. The default is 0.

0 - no unique date / time required

1 - unique date / time required for each requirement.

Hold Engineering Changes

This flag indicates if the system will hold a new schedule if the engineering change value of the new schedule is different to the engineering change value on the contract. The default is 0.

0 - do not hold release

1 - hold release.

Text Processing Method

This is the processing indicator which describes how any customer sent schedule text is actioned. The descriptions are held on the Descriptions file type - TXPM. The default is zero.

0 - Drop text on consolidation

1 - Merge text on consolidation

2 - Earliest text takes precedence

3 - Latest text takes precedence.



Press **Enter** to continue to the Authorisation Codes screen

Company Defaults Release Authorisation Codes Screen



Press **Enter** from the Company Contract and Release Defaults screen to display the Company Defaults Release Authorisation Codes screen.

AC030		Demonstration Company		User QPGMR		29/01/96	
						9:54:22	
Company defaults - Release authorisation codes.							
Authorisation codes	1	2	3	4	5		
Descriptions	<u>FIRM</u>	<u>MATERIAL</u>	<u>FORECAST</u>				
Mandatory reference	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	-	-		
Unique reference	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	-	-		
Fixed horizon days	<u>30</u>	<u>60</u>	<u>180</u>	-	-		
Pass to planning appls.	<u>1</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	-	-		
F3=Exit F12=Previous F21=Release Comparison rules							
09-27 <u>SP</u> <u>MK</u> KS IM II KENB20A PET007S1							



Note: There are five authorisation columns shown in the company, customer, and contract release default screens. These are colour coded as follows:

Period 1 - Red

Period 2 - White

Period 3 - Green

Period 4 - Pink

Period 5 - Blue

Fields:

Description

Enter the authorisation descriptions, typically:

FABRICAT (or FIRM)

MATERIAL

FORECAST

Mandatory Reference

Enter a 1 in this field if a mandatory reference is required, otherwise enter 0.

Unique Reference

This is the unique reference indicator. The default is 0.

0 - no unique reference is required

1 - a unique reference is required.

Fixed Horizon In Days

Enter the fixed horizon as a number of calendar days relative to the previous authorisation code.

If this is the first authorisation code (period 1) it will be relative to the customer stated release date as entered by the user.

This field is only valid if the authorisation method is '04'.

Pass To Planning Applications

Enter a 1 in this field if the schedule requirements for this authorisation period are to be passed as a firm requirement to the MRP / MPS planning system.

Leave blank if not required.



Press **F21=Release Comparison Rules** to enter Release Comparison Rules, or press **Enter** to go to Company Defaults - Daily Call In's if comparison rules are not to be established.

Functions:

F21

This displays the Release Comparison Rules for this Company.

Enter 1 if a rule is the primary rule to be used in the on-line comparison enquiry.

There can only be one primary rule for comparison methods 1 and 2, and one primary rule for methods 3 and 4. At least one rule must be defined as the primary rule.



Press **F8=Update** to return to the Release
Authorisation Code Defaults screen. Then press
Enter to continue.

Company Defaults Daily Call Ins Screen

This screen is only displayed if the DCI / RAN processing indicator is set to 1 or 2.



Press **Enter** from the Company Release Defaults Authorisation Codes screen to display the Company Defaults Daily Call In's screen.

AC035	Demonstration Company	User QPGMR	29/01/96 9:55:15
Company Defaults - Daily Call In's			
DCI/RAN processing 1 (0/1/2) 0=No 1=DCI 2=DCI RAN			
Call-off type 1 0=Daily 1=Timed			
Default time 15:00			
Reconciliation method ...?. 01 cumulative quantity			
Arrears processing method?. 01 Normal Arrears			
Automatic update from EDI?. 4 Validate, compare and accept			
Validation rule?.			
Creation rule?.			
Hold engineering changes .. 0 (0/1)			
Unique date/time 0 (0/1)			
Mandatory reference 0 (0/1)			
Unique reference 0 (0/1)			
Text processing method...?. 0 Drop text on consolidation			
F3=Exit F4=Prompt F8=Update F12=Previous F21=DCI comparison rules			
00-30 SE MK KS IM II KENB20A PET087S1			

Fields:

Call Off Type

This field is used to determine whether the deliveries are made to a time.

0 - Deliveries are not timed. This is the default.

1 - Deliveries are timed.

Default Time

This is where you enter a default time for timed deliveries. This is the time the goods will normally be delivered. Enter the time in HH:MM format. The default is 00:00.

Reconciliation Method

This indicates the type of data supplied by the customer for reconciling new issues. The default is blank, forcing an entry.

'01' - cumulative quantity

'02' - last despatch note

'03' - both (cumulative quantity and last despatch)

'04' - assumed

'05' - Nissan RAN

'06' - none

Arrears Processing Method

This is the method of processing arrears. The default is blank.

'01' - normal arrears. The customer either sends a total of arrears or sends dated requirements which are dated before the issue date.

'02' - restated arrears. The customer restates the arrears either as a new requirement or accumulated in with the forward release. The net result is that the arrears are dated on or after the new issue date.

'03' - assumed arrears. The customer does not send arrears information but assumes that the supplier will still send overdue requirements.

Automatic Update From EDI

This is the automatic update from EDI indicator. The default is blank. Enter one of the following values:

0 - No EDI update

1 - Process into A1 files only

2 - Validate only

3 - Validate and run comparison

4 - Validate, run comparison and update current if all is OK.

Validation Rule

This is the rule for validating EDI transmissions.

Creation Rule

This is the rule for mapping EDI transmissions.

Hold Engineering Changes

This flag indicates if the system will hold a new schedule if the engineering change value of the new schedule is different to the engineering change value on the contract. The default is 0.

0 - do not hold release

1 - hold release.

Unique Date/Time

This is the unique date / time indicator. The default is 0.

0 - no unique date / time required

1 - unique date / time required.

Mandatory Reference

Enter 1 if a reference number must be entered against each requirement, otherwise enter 0 which is the default.

Unique Reference

This is the unique reference indicator. The default is 0.

0 - a unique reference is not required.

1 - a unique reference is required.

Text Processing Method

This is the processing indicator which describes how any customer sent schedule text is actioned. The descriptions are held on the Descriptions file type - TXPM. The default is zero.

0 - Drop text on consolidation

1 - Merge text on consolidation

2 - Earliest text takes precedence

3 - Latest text takes precedence.



Press **F21=DCI Comparison Rules** to update the DCI Comparison Rules.

Functions:

F8

Saves all changes and returns to the menu, or to the Advanced Shipping Company Profile on the first pass.

F21

This displays the DCI Comparison Default Rules screen.

Company Defaults DCI Comparison Rules Screen



Select **F21=DCI Comparison Rules** from the Company DCI Defaults Screen to display the DCI Comparison Rules screen.

You do not have to enter any rules, but any values entered here will be used to default to the customer release comparison rules.

You can add new default rules by entering them at the bottom of the screen, and you can delete any existing rules using option 4 in the select field. To replace or change a rule, you must first delete the original rule, then add the new rule.

Sel	Comparison Method & Description	Rule	Description	Prim.
1	New Rel/Prv rel, latest rev.	001	high Runners,Releases	1

Comparison method.?. _	Rule.....?._	Primary indicator... _
4=Delete		
F3=Exit	F4=Prompt	F8=Update F12=Previous

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Fields:

Comparison Method

Enter a comparison type.

- 1 - New Schedule / Previous Schedule, Latest Version
- 2 - New Schedule / Previous Schedule, Revision Zero
- 3 - New Revision / Previous Revision
- 4 - New Revision / Revision Zero

Comparison Rule

Enter the comparison rule number.

Primary Rule

Enter 1 if a rule is the primary rule to be used in the on-line comparison enquiry.

There can only be one primary rule for comparison methods 1 and 2, and one primary rule for methods 3 and 4. At least one rule must be defined as the primary rule for the on-line Comparison process.



Press **F8=Update** to return to the DCI Defaults screen.



Press **F8=Update** again to update the defaults.

Functions:

F8

Updates the rules and returns to the DCI Defaults screen. **F8** will then be available to update the defaults.

Maintaining Error Severity Overrides



2/ACU

This program allows you to override the default message severities encountered during the validation routines.

Any error that has a severity of four or greater will cause a validation failure. By use of this program all error messages that have had their severity overridden will be displayed, and you can type a new severity value. This value will then be used instead of the system defined default severity.

Maintain Messages Severities Screen 2



Press Enter from the first Maintain Messages Severities Screen to display the second Maintain Messages Severities screen.

```
AC901          Distribution V3 -> V3 Financials    User GJBAPH2    16/02/96
                                                    12:20:38

Maintain Messages Severities

Validation rule..... 01  Default Validation Rule

  Message  Message text                                     Severity
  ────  ───────────────────────────────────────────────────  ────
  █ ACV0020  Final delivery address code does not exist          5
  - ACV0021  Additional destination code does not exist          0
  - ACV0022  Consignee code does not exist                       0

                                                    Bottom
                                                    0

1=Select  4=Delete
F3=Exit   F12=Previous

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```

Fields:

Validation Rule Description

The validation rule description is displayed.

Selection

Enter a 1 next to the rule you want to change. The selected record is copied to the input capable fields below the subfile.

Message Number

You can add a severity override by typing the message number directly into the input field. The error messages are held on the ACMSGF file.

Severity

Enter a number between 0 and 9.



Press **Enter** to continue. The system will validate your entries and update the database.

Start EDI / Validation Sleeper

The EDI / Validation Sleeper runs as a background task.

1... 5/ACU
2...

Overview

Schedule validation will check the incoming schedule data for errors that prevent the data from being processed further through the system.

The source data for the validation process is written by the EDI enabling software and is contained in the Application Interface files. It is also possible that a previous schedule has been resubmitted after you have corrected errors using Schedule Manipulation.

If major errors are detected then the validation process stops. If there are no major errors, the data is transferred to the Advanced Customer Schedule files. Once transferred, a call to a validation routine is made, to check the contents of the transmitted schedule.

If the data is valid, then depending on the configuration of the system, the data may be passed to the schedule comparison process.

If the data is invalid for any reason, the comparison process will not be allowed, but the data must be corrected using Schedule Manipulation or using one of the Process Schedules options - see the section on Processing.

Control

The schedule validation process requires that the schedule that is being validated has been completely written to the Application Interface file by the EDI enabling software. In order to avoid unfinished schedules being passed as validated and processed, the validation process is controlled by a data queue that is fed either:

- When you elect to revalidate from schedule manipulation.
- By a call to a User Exit by the EDI enabling software.

Data Queue

The data queue has the following structure:

- Company
- Customer
- Delivery Sequence
- Contract
- Schedule Type

Data is written to the queue either from the EDI enabler user exit, or from the schedule manipulator routines.

When a record is written from the Enabler, the contract is not known, and consequently all schedules for this customer will be processed.

When a record is written from Schedule Manipulation, the contract is specified and only one schedule is processed.

Whenever a record is written to the queue, the data queue flag in the schedule status file will be updated to allow rebuild of data queues if required.

Exception Processing

All of the errors specified in the validation section have a default severity, and this can be overridden.

Severity Override For Validation Errors

A facility is provided for you to override the severity for errors; this is because some users want certain errors to fail validation, other users will see the error as a warning, and some users will not consider it an error at all. This is because of the wide range of data sources that can be accepted into the system.



Note: For example, the article status code may be considered critical when sent for one customer, but of no interest at all when sent by another.

The error severity override is controlled as follows:

- A check is first made on the inventory descriptions file for this company for a type of record with a code of VARU. If the record is found and its parameter limit is 1, further severity processing is carried out otherwise the program defined severities are used.
- A check will be made on the description file for this company, for a record with a major type VARU, and a minor type equal to the Validation Rule for this customer. If a record is present with a parameter limit of 1 the next stage of severity override is processed. If not, the program defined severities are used.
- You will be able to define an additional validation program to be stored in this descriptions record. This will not be supported in the descriptions file maintenance as yet.
- If an additional validation program is defined for this rule, it will be stored in the general ledger account code field. The name of the program will be the 6 characters from this field.
 - The General Ledger account level field is used to store *when* the extra validation will be called. If the value is B then the extra validation will be called *before* the standard validation, otherwise it will be called *after* the standard. Extra validation will only deal with 'failed validation' type errors, and will never be called before the contract match validation.
 - The General Ledger used field is used to configure whether revalidation is mandatory after schedule manipulation. Any value in this field will result in the schedule being resubmitted to the validation process after manipulation. This facility can be used in conjunction with the preceding two values to allow customised validation.
- If there is a record for a company and a contract validation rule, then severity override is in use and whenever a validation error is detected the file is accessed for the current company, validation rule, and message identifier combination. If no record is found, the default severity is used. If a record is found the error severity for this exception is overridden to 'that specified on the file. If the severity from the file is set to 0 no exception record will be written.



Warning: Errors cannot be overridden if they contain information that is critical to the future processing of the schedule. In this case the overrides can be put into place, but will be ignored in terms of whether or not they cause validation failure.

Whole Schedule Validation

Initially the schedule as a whole is checked to see if it is valid and can be accepted by the system. The processing in this section occurs before the data is transferred to the customer scheduling files. If any of the validation checks fail, the processing status and exception analysis files are updated accordingly, and processing stops.

Contract Match

The customer delivery point is determined by the customer location code. This is converted to the system delivery point using the alternative location reference file. A match between the schedule and the system contract number is made using the following data if sent by the customer:

- Contract number (suppliers order number).
- Customer order number.
- Customer item number.
- Item number or barcode.

If the supplier order number matches a contract for this customer, and the item number is also defined on the same contract, then this is the contract to be used.

Otherwise whichever of the above are sent must be the same on the matched contract. If a successful match can not be made then the exception analysis record will be written stating that the contract could not be matched.

User Specific Contract Match

There is no reason why you cannot set up more than one active contract for the same customer and item combination. This approach is used extensively in the USA at the changeover period between model years. It is not possible to parameterise the contract match process for every possible user requirement, and for this reason a degree of flexibility has been built into the contract match procedure.

There are up to five user defined link fields that can be used to give more differentiation between incoming requirements and allow a more specific match. This is a simple process whereby the User Link field 1 is compared to the contents of the same field at the contract level for this schedule. (If either field is blank this additional match validation will not be performed). If the fields match the contract will be selected; if they do not the schedule will be flagged as unable to match the contract and manual intervention will be required.

- If the contract is matched the active flag for the contract will be checked. If this is not set to 1 an exception analysis record will be written stating that the contract could be matched, but was inactive.
- If the message is a DCI, the DCI processing flag on the contract default record must be 1, otherwise an exception analysis record will be written stating that Daily Call In's are not allowed for this contract.
- If the message is a RAN, the DCI processing flag on the contract default record must be 1, otherwise an exception analysis record will be written stating that RAN's are not allowed for this contract.

Derivation Of Customer Issue Reference, Date And Time

The 'new' schedule files contain the fields:

- Customer Issue Reference.
- Date.
- Time.

These fields are crucial to the unique identification of a particular schedule. For use in the whole schedule validation, these fields will be derived as follows:

Customer Issue Reference

This is mapped into the file using the EDI enabler, and is the reference by which the customer can identify this particular version of the schedule.

Customer Issue Date And Time

These are delivered from the article document date and time if supplied, otherwise from the message document date and time.

Contract Already Has A 'NEW' Schedule

When the contract number is known, a check is made on the status file to determine if any 'new' schedules (DCI, RAN or Release) are ahead of this one in the processing pipeline.

The status file is read using the contract number. If there are any records present for this contract with a data location of 1 (New Files) this schedule cannot be written to the new files, and this is reported as an error, by writing an exception analysis stating that 'another new schedule is already being processed'.

Check for Duplicate Release

If the Update Action Code is not equal to 2, this schedule is not a request to amend an existing schedule, and consequently will be checked to determine whether or not it is a duplicate.

If the customer issue reference and customer issue date and time already exist as the current schedule or in schedule history, this schedule is not accepted: 'Duplicate schedule detected'.

Schedule Amendments

If the Update Action Code is set to 2 this schedule is a request to amend an existing schedule. Amendments cannot be processed before the revision to which they relate is accepted as 'current' Schedule data.

For non RAN type schedules, Previous Document Number, Previous Document Date and Previous Document Time are checked against the Customer Issue Reference, Customer Issue Date and Time on the 'current' schedule. If these do not match the schedule is rejected, and an exception analysis record will be written stating that for release amendment, previous issue details do not match.

Schedule Out Of Sequence

If the issue date / time is earlier than the current schedule sent for this contract / schedule type an exception analysis record will be written stating that a schedule has been received out of sequence.

If a schedule is received out of sequence it is very likely that it will simply be deleted by schedule manipulation sequence, since all non-amendment schedules are whole releases and supersede the previous release entirely.

Invalid Effectivity Dates

If sent, the effective from and effective to dates from the EDI schedule header will be checked against the contract Start and End dates. If the date of the new schedule is outside the date range specified on the contract, an exception analysis record will be stating that a schedule has been received outside of the date range defined on the contract.

Manual Review

This processing will be bypassed if the user has already manually reviewed and accepted a schedule via schedule manipulation.

If the EDI update flag for the contract is set to a value greater than 1, the data transfer to the Advanced Customer Scheduling Files can continue, otherwise the data is only processed as far as the Application Interface files and must then be manually approved before passing to the 'new' files. If this is the case, an exception analysis record will state 'This Schedule is Pending Review' and may be reviewed via Schedule Maintenance or Process EDI Error Transactions.

The user will then need to confirm that processing can continue, or remove the schedule from the system, by taking the appropriate action within Schedule Manipulation.

EDI Data Mapping

If all the above validation is passed, the schedule status code will be set to 'No Errors'. The internal release number will be derived for this particular Contract / Schedule.

Internal Release Tracking

The current internal release number is stored on the Contract file. This will only ever be updated by the schedule acceptance process.

A new release can be detected by checking the Update Action Code in the EDI database. If this code has a value of 2 this is considered to be a revision, otherwise the customers issue reference is compared to that for the current release. If they are the same this is considered to be a revision.

If this is a new release the new internal release number will be derived by adding 1 to the current internal release number and setting the new internal revision reference to zero.

If this is not a new release, the new internal revision number will be derived by adding 1 to the current internal revision number.

Once the release and revision have been derived, they will be updated to the schedule status file.

The data will be then be transferred from the Application Interface files to the Advanced Customer Schedule files.

Data Derivation

Internal Line Number

When writing a schedule requirement the lines will be numbered sequentially starting from 1. The value will be stored, and is used as the link from schedule line to the appropriate line text. Thus if 10 lines are written the lines will be numbered from 1 to 10.

Text Processing

Text will have been written by the EDI Enabler if any was sent with the schedule. The records can be one of two record types:

Type H

Contains item text and will be stored as external text at schedule header level.

Type D

Contains delivery text and will be stored as external text at schedule detail level.

Up to 3 records can be captured for each text type, and since the text data field is twice as long in the EDI system as in the application, up to 6 text records can be generated per text type. However the text generation routine will not limit to a maximum of 6 text lines.

Special Processing For Release Amendments

If the update action code is 2 this is an amendment to a previous schedule. Most companies provide a whole new schedule to cover this situation, but it is understood that some companies currently use date range release amendments.

An amendment can either:

- Replace existing delivery requirement records with new ones, discretely, specifying the new quantity for a specific date and time.
- Replace a block of requirements as specified by the date range.

Release amendments are handled during the transfer of data from the Application Interface files to the Advanced Customer Scheduling files.

If the release received is an amendment the 'based on' release will be copied from the current release. (A check will have already been performed to ensure that this is the release to which the amendments apply). The data from the new schedule is then used to replace the amended details in the current release.

If the date ranges are specified all records from the current requirement that fall within the specified date range will be excluded from the copy.

If the discrete method is used all requirements will be copied.

The new schedule data is copied over the top of the working copy of the current schedule, requirements with a common date and time are overwritten from the new release (not retained from the current).

This ensures that all the data which was not sent has been inherited from the current release. All processing is then the same regardless of whether or not this is an amendment.

When the data has been transferred the data location on the schedule status file will be set to 'new'.

A call is then made to the schedule detail validation program. It may be necessary to call the validation rule specific validation program at this point, or after the detail validation has finished.

Schedule Detail Validation

The schedule detail validation is driven from the Advanced Customer Schedule files. Processing does not abort on error so many validation errors could be reported for a schedule. If additional validation is specified it will be called either before or after that specified here. The extra validation program is not responsible for update of the schedule status file, but only for writing of exception analysis records.

Special Considerations For RAN Processing

Most of the validation for RANs is common with Releases and DCIs. However the following processing overrides any that has been described for other type of schedules.

- If any particular RAN is an amendment the call off reference is checked against the call off reference in the current reconciled requirement file. If this RAN is not present an exception analysis record will be written, stating: 'A RAN amendment has been received, but the original RAN does not exist.'
- If the RAN exists but has been fully despatched, then an exception analysis record will state: 'A RAN amendment has been received, but the original RAN has been despatched.'
- If the RAN is a creation the call off reference will be checked against both this transmission and the current reconciled requirement file. If the RAN number exists in either place an exception analysis record will be written stating that: 'A new RAN has been received, but a requirement with this RAN number already exists.'

Date Validation

As a general rule all dates must be valid calendar dates. If a date is invalid, then unless an override action is specified, specific to the date in question, an exception analysis record will be specified. The message written will be specific to the field, not a general invalid date message.

Time Validation

If the call off type for this contract is 'timed', delivery times must also be valid on the 24 hour clock. If they are not an exception analysis record will be written. Time 00:00 will be considered to be valid. This is the only time based processing in the acceptance process. Time is not used in reconciliation processing.

Date Of New Release

This date will be validated as for other dates. The severity when invalid can never be less than 4 for invalid dates. The default severity is 9.

Despatch Note Validation

Despatch note validation will only be performed if the reconciliation method on the contract for this schedule type is 2 or 3. If it is, validation should occur on each non-blank despatch note number against the schedule despatch details. If any of the despatch notes quoted do not exist an exception analysis record will be written.

All quantities are checked against the equivalent from the file. (For each quantity, an error message is written stating that the quantity is different.) If the error (overridden or otherwise) is a warning then the quantity discrepancy will be written to a field on the schedule header. If the error is not a warning this field is not updated.

If any of the other despatch note information (e.g. Quantity) does not exist, it will be defaulted from the record. The files provide for up to six last despatch details; these will be driven by the despatch note numbers. If, however, any information exists without the despatch note number, an exception analysis record will be written. In this way the information will be presented in schedule manipulation, but will be ignored by all further processing.

Reconciliation Method Validation

If the reconciliation method for this schedule type is '01' (Cum Only) or '03' (Cum and Last Despatch note) the customer must have stated a cumulative receipts figure. This field may be positive, negative, or zero. If this field is 0 no cumulative receipts were supplied and this is an error. If an error is detected, an exception analysis record will be written.

Final Delivery Address Code And Additional Destination

Few customers will require this validation. For this reason the default action will be to ignore this validation. If you do require this validation it can be switched on by creating a severity override record with a severity of greater than 0.

These codes will be validated against the Advanced Shipping Names and Addresses file, for this company, customer, delivery sequence. An exception analysis record will only be written if an override is present in the severity override file. If present, an exception analysis record will be written for each code. If the severity is less than 4, or the error is not required, these codes will be defaulted to the delivery sequence.

Consignee/Carrier/Freight Forwarder

You may not require this validation immediately. For this reason the default action will be to ignore this validation. If you do require this validation it can be switched on by creating a severity override record with a severity of greater than 0.

This code will be validated against the Advanced Shipping Names and Addresses file, for this company, customer, delivery sequence. An exception analysis record will only be written if an override is present in the severity override file. If not present, an exception analysis record will be written for each code.

Authorisation End Dates

These dates are only checked if the authorisation method for the schedule on the contract is '02 - Date Horizons'.

These dates must match the periods defined on the contract. If n periods are defined on the contract, $(n-1)$ end dates must be sent by the customer. If the dates are invalid, or out of sequence, an exception analysis record will be written. The message will state the period in error.

Authorisation Period Cumulatives

These quantities are only checked if the authorisation method for the schedule on the contract is 1 or 3 (cumulative quantity). These quantities must match the periods defined on the contract. If n periods are defined on the contract, (n-1) cumulatives must be sent by the customer. Cumulatives can be zero. If an error is detected, an exception analysis record will be displayed. The message will state the period in error.

Article Status Code

The supported values for article status code are:

- '01' New Article.
- '02' Obsolete Article.
- '03' Current Article.
- '04' Engineering Change.
- '05' Re-instated Article.
- '06' Spares.
- '07' Critical Article.
- '08' Non Current.
- '09' Superseding Article.

If the article status code is anything other than '03' an exception analysis record will be written for default severity 1, minimum severity 0. If the article status code is '04', and the hold on engineering change flag is set to yes, then use default severity 4, minimum severity 0. Different error messages will be used for each code, which will allow the user to convert certain codes to errors that cause a validation failure, and to suppress validation of others. The default action is to provide a warning message.

A 'catch all' error will be specified if an article status code is received which has not had an error message defined for it.

Release Type Code

The possible values for release type code are:

- 1 - Ship by.
- 2 - Receive by.
- 3 - In manufacturing by.
- 4 - At distribution centre by.

If the code is 1, and the ship lead time on the contract is not zero then an exception analysis record will be written. This is because if the customer is supplying ship by dates, then it is probably wrong to apply lead times.

Engineering Change / Design Revision Number

If either field is not sent by the customer, then it is assumed to be the same as the current value from the contract.

These fields will be checked against the current values as held on the contract. If either field is different to the contract equivalent, then there has been an engineering change. If there has been no change, the rest of this validation is not performed.

The new engineering level and design revision number will be looked up on the engineering level change file. If an engineering change at this design revision level does not exist then this is an error since the customer has requested an unknown engineering level. If this happens, an exception analysis record will be written. The message will state that: 'An engineering change has occurred, but the new level is not defined'. No further validation is performed.

If there has been an engineering change, and the new level is defined on the file, the hold on engineering level change flag on the contract will be checked. This flag determines whether to treat an engineering change as a warning (flag=0) or as an error (flag=1).

- If the hold engineering change field on the contract is set to 0 and there has been a change, then an exception analysis record will be written stating that: 'An engineering change has occurred'.
- If the hold engineering change field on the contract is set to 1 and there has been a change, an exception analysis record will be written stating that: 'An engineering change has occurred' and the Schedule will be updated to 'Add' status.

First Date Display Format And Date

This code describes the format of the date sent as 'First Date'. The field will be checked on each record for this schedule. Valid values are:

0 - YYMMDD.

1 - WWYY.

2 - MMY.

3 - PPYY.

If the code is not one of the above then an exception analysis record will be written for whichever field is different.

The first date will then be checked to ensure that it is a valid date in the specified format. This must be valid as defined on the current contract calendar, but does not need to be a working day. If it is invalid an exception analysis record will be written.

If the date format is 0, and delivery rounding is inactive for the contract, the date will be validated against the working day calendar for the contract. If it is invalid, an exception analysis record will be written.

Authorisation Status

The authorisation status is only checked if the authorisation method for this schedule is defined on the contract as 01 (Customer Sent). In this case the authorisation status codes must be consistent with those on the contract. It is important that if the contract specifies 4 periods, the number sent by the customer does not exceed this. If it does, an exception analysis record will be written.

Call Off Reference

The call off reference will only be checked if the mandatory and / or unique reference flags are set to yes on the contract.

If the reference is mandatory it will be checked that it is non-blank. If it is then an exception analysis record will be written.

If the reference is required to be unique it will be checked against the other references in this schedule. If there are no other lines within this schedule with the same reference, it will be checked against previous requirements. If the reference does not exist in the reconciled requirement file, it can be considered to be unique. If it is not, an exception analysis record will be written.

Account Status Checks

The account status will be checked in the same way as SOP order entry. This means that if the customer (or hierarchy) is on stop, litigation stop, credit limit exceeded etc, a record will be written to the exception analysis file, describing the error condition. The default severities for these messages will be 9 when order entry prevents entry of an order, and 4 when an order can be entered but becomes suspended (the severity 4 messages can be allocated a higher priority if required).



Note: Severity 4 messages will be 'Failed'.

Validation Failure

At the end of the validation process, if any exception analysis records have been written with a severity of higher than or equal to 4, the schedule status file will be updated to status 'Failed Validation', and the processing state will be set to 0 (None). The Schedule details can be reviewed and corrected using Schedule Manipulation.

Validation Successful

Once a schedule has been validated and has no errors that cause a validation failure, certain calculations are required. These calculations will update the authorisation period information contained within the schedule, and are described below:

Reconciliation Calculations

These calculations are called when the customer does not supply a cumulative receipts figure. These calculations will be performed by means of a sub-process, which has the following function:

Goods In Transit

A call will be made to the goods in transit calculation function written for the comparison routines. This function will calculate the goods in transit value.

Contract Cumulative YTD

This field is calculated by retrieving the contract cumulative despatches YTD and subtracting the cumulative adjustment (calculated, if applicable, in last despatch note validation).

Calculated Cumulative Receipts

Calculated Cumulative receipts are calculated by subtracting the goods in transit at present from the contract cum despatches.

Authorisation Period Calculations

The authorisation period calculations depend upon the authorisation period set for the contract.

Once the authorisation period calculations have been performed, a data queue entry will be written to submit the schedule to the comparison process, providing that the automatic update from EDI flag is set to allow this.

If the EDI Update flag is set to any value greater than 2, progression to the next stage is allowed.

The schedule status file will be updated to status 'No Error', and the processing state will be set to the correct value to indicate Pending Review or Comparison Process Next.

Start Comparison Sleeper



6/ACU

When a new release is received, it is vital that the impact of any changes are assessed. The comparison process provides a method of treating large impact changes as exceptions. You can set up the required tolerances at the contract level.

It is important here to differentiate between non-RAN type DCI's, which are functionally like mini-releases, and RAN type DCI's which are discrete requirements never repeated on subsequent releases.

RAN type DCI's do not state an arrears amount but arrears are assumed to be sent. It is therefore meaningless to compare RAN type DCI's with each other. If a RAN is encountered then no comparison will occur, and the Comparison Successful processing will occur immediately.

Background

A difference between the previous release and the new release can be caused by one or more of the following factors:-

- The customer has increased / decreased their requirements.
- There are in-transit despatches at the time of the new release.
- The customer has received a different quantity from the quantity shipped. Typically the customer has rejected material and their statement of cumulative receipts is therefore different from the suppliers statement of cumulative despatches.

It will be apparent that the cause of a 'difference' will determine the nature of the suppliers response. For example if the difference can be attributed to in-transit despatches no action may be required.

When a customer sends a new release it is often normal practice for the customer to state the arrears situation. This is the customers statement of what they consider to be overdue from the previous release at the synchronisation (cut-off) date / time of the new release. However, if the customer under estimated their firm requirements, or avoided commitment and financial exposure to them, it is easy for the customer to inflate the arrears total in order to sneak the extra requirements in to the new release. This practice is widely known as 'front loading'.

It is difficult for the supplier to be able to tell the difference between whether the customer is 'front loading', or whether the arrears can be accounted for by a combination of in-transit, customer returns and genuine arrears. As a means of achieving this it is necessary to be able to compare the customer stated arrears with the current release and the receipts information sent by the customer.

As well as being able to detect 'front loading', it is also highly desirable to be able to detect sudden changes in requirements in the near future. The customer is expected to conform to a pattern of adhering more or less to their original release. Obviously this varies greatly from customer to customer, as does the ability of the supplier to do anything about it. However it is important for the supplier to be able to detect sudden changes which could have an impact on business.

In a non-DCI scheduling environment, changes in requirements can be calculated between different release versions and even between interim revisions.

In a DCI type of environment releases and DCI's will co-exist for the same contract. The customer release is a forecast for the mid to long term and might represent a commitment on the part of the customer for the cost of materials. Daily Call In's (DCI's) are sent by the customer on a day by day basis. They are firm requirements for the near future. In this type of environment it is still desirable to be able to compare the firm requirements(DCI's) with earlier DCI's covering the same period. It is also desirable to be able to compare the firm requirements(DCI's) with earlier forecasts(releases), so essentially the processing will be the same.

The information sent by customers that helps the supplier determine whether there are in-transit despatches or receipt/despatch quantity discrepancies, can include details of despatch notes received, quantities and cumulative quantities received. The information sent varies from customer to customer. At one extreme, cumulative receipts to date, the last four despatch notes and the shipments to date at the time of their receipt are sent. At the other extreme, nothing is sent.

The 'normal' situation in the UK, at least for manual releases, is that the last despatch note number is sent. In the US the cumulative receipts YTD is occasionally sent, often with the last despatch note number.

Differences will be, wherever possible, detected and accounted for. Where necessary, cut-off information will be corrected by the supplier. This avoids errors being compounded from release to release. For example, the supplier would normally correct his cumulative despatch to date figure to bring it in to line with the customer cumulative receipts to date figure.

Overview

Users can define a number of comparison rules for use in the comparison process. Different rules can be applied to Releases or DCIs for the same contract.

Rules are defined by selecting from five pre-defined rule elements. These elements define the tests that are applied to the new schedule, when the rule becomes associated with a contract. Rule element 5 must be unique within the rule, but the others may exist more than once in the same rule, each occurrence having different tolerance values for time and date ranges.

Rule Elements are:

Type 1

Quantity Within Period.

Type 2

Cumulative at Authorisation Period End (New Date Only).

Type 3

Cumulative at Authorisation Period End (New & Current Date).

Type 4

Cumulative at High Water Mark.

Type 5

Cumulative Mismatch.

Once a rule has been defined, it can be associated with a contract or contracts. This association must be modified by the selection of a comparison method while creating the link.

The four types of comparison method:

Type 1

New Schedule Compared to Previous Schedule at Latest Revision

Type 2

New Schedule Compared to Previous Schedule at Revision Zero.

Type 3

New Revision Compared to Previous Revision

Type 4

New Revision Compared to Revision Zero

The comparison methods condition:

When the rule is applied, methods 1 and 2 are only applied to new releases of a schedule, while 3 and 4 are only applied to revisions of existing schedules, with which previous release or revision the comparison will be made.

Control

This program is initiated when a data queue entry is detected specifying the contract to process. As soon as the queue entry is received, the schedule status file processing state will be set to Processing active.

As soon as the process starts, the contract will be checked to determine whether it has been locked. If not, it will be locked immediately. If the contract is locked the general record locking processing will occur. This lock will not prevent shipping from occurring.

Exception Processing

The comparison process reads each valid schedule in turn and processes it against the predefined comparison method / rule number combinations. Any schedule which has one or more comparison exceptions with a severity of four or greater will be held pending a manual review. It will be possible to accept the schedule with unresolved comparison errors, (if you are authorised to do so), from within schedule manipulation.

Exception Analysis

Exceptions are written to the Release Exception Analysis File. When an exception is detected, the record is built deriving the data basically from the comparison defaults file.

Comparison Processing

The first step in the process is to determine whether or not there are any comparison rules defined for the current contract.

The rules will be read by company, type (release or DCI) and contract from the file. If the current Internal Revision is '000' this is a new release and only comparison methods 1 and 2 are applicable. If the internal revision is greater than '000' only comparison methods 3 and 4 are applicable.

If there are no applicable comparison rules defined against it the contract will be considered to have passed comparison, and the processing described in 'Comparison Successful' on page will occur.

The authorisation method, reconciliation method and arrears processing method on the new schedule are checked against those on the current schedule, and if any of them are different a warning error (severity 1, minimum severity 0) is issued describing the discrepancy. This will not prevent processing.

For each applicable comparison method then the following comparison processing will be carried out.

Comparison Processing By Rule Element

This section is intended to give a brief description of the comparison processing. The logic involved in the comparison process is complex.

All rules that are applicable will be read. Rules that are not applicable at the current Internal Revision Level will be ignored. For those rules that are applicable, the individual rule elements will be read from file, and processed regardless of other comparison errors that have been detected.



Note: Where the tolerance values are blank on the Comparison Rules record, these are not used and tolerance checking will be ignored. Where the value is zero, tolerance checking will occur.

Type 1 Quantity Within Period

This will check the required quantity in the new schedule at a specific point in time relative to the customer issue date, against the same information in the current schedule.

If the current schedule has an Arrears processing method that is not equal to 1 (normal arrears), or a reconciliation method equal to 5 (Nissan RAN), this element type will be ignored.

If the current rule element has a negative value in the To/From days field, calculate the expected arrears value. Compare the expected arrears to the Customer Stated Arrears. If any of the tolerances defined for the rule element (on the current record) are exceeded, write an exception record.

For each rule element that has a positive value in the To/From days field, calculate the new requirement quantity and the current requirement quantity for that time period in relation to the processing date and customer issue date. Compare the new requirement quantity with the current requirement quantity. If any of the tolerances defined for the rule element (on the current record) are exceeded, write an exception record.

Type 2 Cumulative At Authorisation Period End (New Date Only)

This will check the current cumulative against the new one, but only at the dates that form the authorisation period ends in the new schedule.

For each rule element type 2, the value of the Authorisation Period in Comparison Rule file is checked. The new cumulative requirement and the current cumulative requirement is calculated as at the authorisation period end date in the new schedule. The new cumulative requirement is compared with the current cumulative requirement. If any of the tolerances defined for the rule element (on the current Comparison Rule record) are exceeded, an exception record is written.

Type 3 Cumulative At Authorisation Period End (New And Current Date)

The cumulative YTD at the end of an authorisation period (the period to compare is defined against the rule element) on the 'new' release is compared with the cumulative YTD on the 'current' release at the end of the authorisation period on the 'current' release. If any of the tolerances defined for the rule element (on the current Comparison Rule record) are exceeded, an exception record is written.

Type 4 Cumulative At High Water Mark

The cumulative requirement YTD at the end of the authorisation period on the NEW release (the period to compare is defined against the rule element), is compared with the High Water Mark Cumulative for that authorisation status on the contract record. If any of the tolerances defined for the rule element (on the current Comparison Rule record) are exceeded, an exception record is written.

Type 5 Cumulative Mismatch

This rule element is only valid when a customer sends cumulative receipts to date and one or more last despatch numbers. Therefore if the reconciliation method is not equal to 3, this check will not be performed.

The customer's stated cum receipts as of a given despatch number are compared to the system calculated cum despatches as of the same despatch number. Theoretically the two will be the same, but for a variety of reasons in practice there is often a mismatch. This rule element type allows the user to have the system automatically highlight cum mismatch situations. If any of the tolerances defined for the rule element are exceeded then an exception record will be generated.

Comparison Failure

If any errors of severity four or higher were detected, the schedule can be considered to have failed comparison. In this case the schedule status file will be updated to status Failed comparison, and the last process to Compare. Record locks on the contract will be released. The Schedule will be available for review in Schedule Manipulation.

Comparison Successful

If the comparison was successful, the schedule status file will be updated to status No Error. The last process to Compare Record locks on the contract will be released.

If the EDI Update flag is set to any value greater than 3, progression to the next stage is allowed by generating the appropriate Data Queue entry for the Acceptance Sleeper process.

Start Schedule Update Sleeper



7/ACU

Schedule Acceptance is the process of accepting a new release from a customer to replace their current release. New releases / DCI's which have been validated, accepted by the comparison sleeper (or manually approved) and are now available to the Acceptance Sleeper process.

This section as a whole does not apply to RAN type processing which is identified by reconciliation method 5='Nissan RAN'. It does however cover mini-release type RAN processing (as used by Sony for example).

There are five phases in the New Release / DCI Update Process.

- Calculate cut-off Data & Flag Reconciled Despatches.
- Update High Water cumulatives on the Contract.
- Build New Reconciled Requirements Work File.
- New to Current Update.
- Update Reconciled Requirements.

Control

Record Locking

As soon as the process starts, the contract will be locked. This lock will prevent shipping from occurring.

RAN Amendments

It is possible that for RAN amendments, the RAN to which an amendment applies has been despatched by the time the acceptance process starts. It is necessary to validate to ensure this has not happened. If it has, the acceptance process will be aborted.

For RAN type schedules when the update action code is 'Amendment', a check will be made to ensure that the RAN quoted in the call off reference exists in the current reconciled requirement. If the RAN does not exist or has been completed an exception analysis record will be written stating that for release amendment of a RAN, the original RAN does not exist (or has been despatched).

No further processing will occur for this RAN.

If this happens it will be necessary to amend the schedule using schedule manipulation, and after consultation with the customer, either delete the amended requirement or add a new requirement with a mutually agreed reference.

Account Status Checks

The account status will be checked in the same way as order entry. This means that if the customer (or hierarchy) is on stop, litigation stop, credit limit exceeded etc, a record will be written to the exception analysis file, describing the error condition. The default severities for these messages will be 9 when order entry prevents entry of an order, and 4 when an order can be entered but becomes suspended (the severity 4 messages can be allocated a higher priority if required).



Note: Severity 4 is 'Failed'.

Schedule Status

The schedule status for the schedule can be 0 (No Error) or 6 (Failed Comparison) or 7 (Failed Acceptance) and the data location must be in the new files. The last process must be 2=Comparison.

RAN Acceptance Processing

RAN acceptance differs from that for normal schedules. Normal acceptance processing will occur for RANs, with the exception of the following sections. The processing outlined below will be performed instead of normal processing when accepting a RAN.

- Update High Water Cumulatives on the Contract
- Build New Reconciled Requirements Work File.

Update High Water Cumulatives

No update of High Water Cumulatives is performed for RAN schedules.

Build Reconciled Requirements Work File

All outstanding reconciled requirements will be copied from the current schedule.

- For amendments the Reconciled Requirements Work file record will be updated to reflect the new information from the new Schedule.
- For additions a new record will be written to Reconciled Requirements Work file.

No delivery frequency or pack rounding will occur, but the reconciled requirement will be ship lead time adjusted.



Note: Existing Reconciled Requirements records will already have been lead time adjusted and will not be re-adjusted.

Reconciled Requirement Text

Reconciled requirement text generation will occur as for the non-RAN processing. The processing will be less complicated for RAN since by definition none of the rounding processes are performed.

Non RAN Processing

The acceptance process will run for a particular contract and schedule type.

Calculate Cut Off Data / Reconcile Despatches

Calculation of Goods In Transit (GIT)



Note: It will be noted that the calculation of GIT is similar to that defined in the comparison process. When the GIT has been calculated, it is updated to the new schedule header.

The calculation depends heavily on the reconciliation method defined on the contract for the particular release or DCI being processed.

If the reconciliation method is 1 (Cumulative Only), the GIT is calculated by subtracting the customer stated cumulative receipts (new schedule) from the calculated cumulative despatches, i.e. the sum of all despatches made against this contract.

If the reconciliation method is 2 (Last Despatch Note number), the GIT is calculated by subtracting the despatches known to have been received by the customer, from those recorded by the system. This is achieved by flagging despatches as received if they occurred earlier than the earliest despatch advised by the customer. Any despatches advised by the customer will also be flagged as complete. (Any despatch confirmation supplied by the customer is also updated at this point). The GIT is now the sum of all shipments that are not flagged as received.

If the reconciliation method is 3 (Cumulative Quantity and Last Despatch Note number), the GIT is calculated in exactly the same way as if the reconciliation method is 1. In addition, however, the last despatch reconciliation that was described for reconciliation method 2 is also performed. This method allows those companies that wish to use reconciliation method 1 to maintain the integrity of their despatch information.

If the reconciliation method is 4 (Assumed), all shipments made are assumed to have been received by the customer, if the delivery lead time is accounted for. For this method the GIT is calculated by flagging all despatches as received, if the calculated receipt date (based on shipping date and lead time) is before the customer issue date for this release. The GIT is now the sum of all shipments that are not flagged as received.

If the reconciliation method is 5 (Nissan RAN), the requirement is discrete and the GIT value can be considered to be 0. No update is made to the despatch records.

If the reconciliation method is 6 (None), the GIT is simply calculated by flagging all despatches made prior to or on the customer issue date as received, and totalling all despatches that have not yet been received.

Reconciliation methods are defined in the inventory descriptions file, and as such, methods not described here may be considered valid by the file maintenance programs. If another method is encountered then default to method 6.

Update Contract High Water Cumulatives

The contract high water cumulatives are updated for releases and DCI's only. They are set using the authorisation period cumulatives stored on the schedule header.

The high water cumulatives on the contract are then updated for each authorisation period where the period requirement is higher than the current value.

Build New Reconciled Requirements

This file is used to merge outstanding requirements with new requirements, applying any adjustments necessary according to the arrears processing method.

The difference is calculated between customer stated and actual (system calculated) arrears. The calculation is conditioned by the arrears processing method. The actual position can be agreement (no arrears), front loading or genuine (arrears), backloading (reducing commitment), or an over-shipment.

Previously reconciled requirements are copied from the current reconciled requirement file to the workfile used in this process. The selected requirements are those earlier than the customer issue date (ship lead time adjusted), that have not already been flagged as fully despatched by the shipping process. This requirement is then adjusted by the arrears or over-shipped quantity to give a true picture of the requirement at the customer issue date.

If arrears exist at the time, a new reconciled requirement will be created for the arrears quantity and dated as the customer issue date. It will be noted that if the contract specifies the use of unique call-off references, all discrete requirements will be retained and all will be re-dated as the customer issue date. This will allow the unique reference to be quoted on despatch documentation.

The requirements from the new schedule are then also added to the work file. If a remaining over-shipped or arrears quantity exists, this is then used to adjust the first dated requirement.

Any records in the workfile that are for a time period other than daily (e.g. there could be a monthly requirement present), are then pro-rated over the number of delivery days in the period to create daily ship requirements

If the contract requires that delivery frequency rounding be applied, the workfile records are then adjusted accordingly.

If the contract requires that pack rounding be applied, the workfile records are then adjusted accordingly. (Individual requirement records may be flagged as pack rounding inhibited and are not included in this process).

The requirement records are then finally adjusted for shipping lead time to plan to ship the requirement on the latest working day that will allow it to be delivered in time.



Warning: It is important that pack rounding will not occur across authorisation periods, nor will they occur if the unique reference flag (on the contract) for this schedule type if set to 1.



Note: The Advanced Shipping Contract File has a flag 'Lead Time Adjust Forecast'. If this flag is set to zero, lead time adjustment will apply only to firm (first authorised period) requirement, otherwise it will apply to all requirements.

Reconciled Requirement Text

All reconciled requirement text is removed. The text is stored with a text type G, a usage code E and a text reference of contract, and reconciled requirement line number. This text is then replaced with the reconciled record.

Reconciled requirement text can only be external in this version of advanced customer scheduling. Internal text can be entered against a schedule requirement, but this is not, at present, carried forward to the reconciled requirement.

Each schedule detail requirement may have text associated with it either supplied by the customer or added by schedule manipulation.

When lines are combined or adjusted according to pack rounding etc. the original schedule details lines making up the reconciled requirement lines will be retained and reconciled requirement text generated according to the text processing on the contract for this schedule type.

The text processing method can have the following values:

- 0 - Reconciled requirement text is not generated.
- 1 - Reconciled requirement text is merged from the constituent schedule lines.
- 2 - Reconciled requirement text is retained from the first constituent schedule line.
- 3 - Reconciled requirement text is retained from the last constituent schedule line.

Once finalised, each reconciled requirement record will be allocated a text reference, which is a sequential number starting from 1. This will be stored as the reconciled requirement line number.

Reconciled requirement text records, derived from the schedule details text, according to the text processing method (see above) are then written to the inventory text file. The text type is G (reconciled requirement text) and the usage code is E (external). The text reference is the contract, schedule type and internal line number.

Update Reconciled Requirements

Once the reconciled requirements have been calculated, they can be copied over into the current requirements. The current reconciled requirements are first moved into the reconciled requirement history file. All new requirements from the workfile are then moved to current.

New To Current Update

The current schedule is first moved into the schedule history files. All text records for the current schedule are removed from the inventory text file for this schedule (schedule text is not archived to history). The schedule text for the new schedule is then written to the text file.

The Schedule Header is updated as follows:

- The date and time the new release became current will be updated to the current date and time.
- The engineering level and design revision number of this schedule are updated to the equivalent fields in the contract. If either field is blank, the contract is not updated.

If there is a non-zero cumulative adjustment on this schedule header, this will be subtracted from the contract YTD cum, and an audit record written.

Acceptance Unsuccessful

At the end of the acceptance process, if any exception analysis records have been written with a severity of four or higher, the schedule status file will be updated to status 7 (Failed). The schedule can be corrected using Schedule Manipulation.

All record locks are removed.

Acceptance Successful

Once acceptance is completed successfully, the schedule status record for the contract and type (current release and revision) is changed from current to History to signify that this schedule is now in the history file, and the data location flag is changed to History. The last process is changed to Acceptance, and the processing state set to successful.

The schedule status record for the new release and revision is updated to 'current' to signify that this is now the current release. The last process is updated to 3 (Acceptance), and the processing flag is set to Inactive.

The schedule additional details file is then updated to show the current internal release and revision.

All record locks are removed.

Schedule History Purge

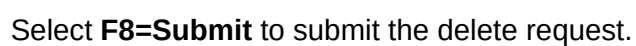


20/ACU

This option allows you to remove old schedules to help maintain your system.



Select Schedule History Purge from the menu to display the Schedule History Purge screen.



Fordnet / PC File Transfer



30/ACU

Fordnet is an EDI enabler product entirely PC based and produces PC files to hold message data.

This option allows you to transfer the data held in the PC files to and from an interface file on an AS/400.

PC File Transfer Screen

This screen allows you to select transfer documents and transfer locations. While the selected document is being transferred a progress window displays file transfer information.

-  Select Fordnet / PC File Transfer from the menu to display the PC File Transfer screen.

AC830Z1 - GB Demonstration CompanyUser GBJBACHG20/10/9713:55:35

PC File Transfer

Transfer Document Type. ?

Transfer Doc. Location. ?

F3=Exit F4=Prompt

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Fields:

Transfer Document Type

Enter the Fordnet document type code.

Transfer Doc Location

Enter the Fordnet shared folders code which indicates where to transfer the document to.

-  Select **Enter** to confirm the data and make the transfer.